Health Information Access Request (AHS form 18577)

Fillable working copy, with a plain-language guide

READ THIS FIRST

This is a fillable working copy that captures everything the official Alberta Health Services (AHS) form 18577 asks. It opens and fills on any phone, tablet or computer. It is NOT an official Alberta Health Services form.

The official form is at **albertahealthservices.ca/frm-18577.pdf**. If the Disclosure Help Line asks for the official form, download it from that link and copy your answers over.

This copy was rebuilt from the current official version, 18577 (Rev2026-07), on 5 November 2026.

What this form is for

This form is how you ask Alberta Health Services for copies of your own hospital and health records. You can also use it to ask for someone else's records if you have the legal authority to act for them, for example as the parent of a child under 18, or as a guardian, trustee or power of attorney.

Why it matters for AISH, ADAP and other benefits

Your records are your evidence. They help when you:

- apply for AISH, or ask to move from ADAP to AISH
- appeal a decision, or ask for an exemption
- apply for the Disability Tax Credit or CPP Disability
- start with a new doctor who needs your history

Bring copies to your doctor before they fill out a medical report. A report that points to your records is stronger than one written from memory.

Try this first: MyChart and your MyHealth Alberta Account

- **MyChart:** if you have a MyChart account, you can ask for your records there, and you do not need to send ID. Log in, open **Menu**, choose **Sharing Hub**, choose yourself, then **Request a copy of health records**. AHS says a minimum fee applies to all requests, including this one.
- **MyHealth Alberta Account** (myhealth.alberta.ca/account): shows many of your test results, like bloodwork and imaging reports, once your account is verified. Check there first. You may already have what you need.

About the form itself

Form number	18577 (Rev2026-07), printed at the bottom of every page
Official title	Health Information Access Request
Who it goes to	Alberta Health Services, Disclosure Help Line. The help line is run by Health Shared Services, which is why the email address ends in healthsharedservices.ca.
Law it uses	Alberta's Health Information Act. The form says informal requests are made under section 17.

Security	Once filled in, this form holds your health card number and personal details. Do not post it, and do not send it to anyone but the Disclosure Help Line.
Pages	The official form is 3 pages. Page 1 of the official form is Part A here, and page 2 is Part B. Page 3 is information only, and everything on it is explained in this guide. This working copy is longer because the boxes are bigger, so they are easier to fill in on a phone.
Official link	https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/frm-18577.pdf

Who fills in what

Part A	Everyone. The patient's details, your contact details, informal or formal request, which records you want, how you want them delivered, and your signature.
Part B	ONLY if you are not the patient. Why you need the records, and what gives you the legal authority to ask for them. You must send proof, like a guardianship order or power of attorney.

Informal or formal: you must pick one

Both options get you the same records. AHS says records are released based on what you ask for, not on the option you pick. The difference is the process.

Option 1: Informal	Option 2: Formal
Minimum fee of $25.	Minimum fee of $25.
May be done faster.	AHS has up to 30 days to answer, and can extend that by up to 30 more days.
You only get a fee estimate if you ask for one.	If costs will be more than $50, you get a written estimate first. Work stops until you accept it. You have 20 days to accept it or change your request. If you do nothing for 30 days, your request is closed.
Cannot be reviewed by the Information and Privacy Commissioner.	You can ask the Information and Privacy Commissioner (OIPC) to review AHS's response.

Which one should I pick? For most people, informal is the simpler choice. Pick formal if you think records might be held back, or you want the right to an independent review of what AHS sends you.

Note from the form: requests for another person's health information without their consent, where the law allows it (section 35(1) of the Health Information Act), are always handled as informal, even if you pick formal.

Fees

- Do NOT send money with your request. The invoice comes with your records.
- Every request costs at least $25.
- If it will cost more than $50, you get an estimate to approve first (formal requests).
- For paper copies, AHS says the basic fee covers up to 100 printed pages.

Which records to ask for

Discharge Summary	The doctor's summary written when you left the hospital.

Emergency Room Records	Notes from your emergency room visits.
Operative/Procedure Reports	What was done during a surgery or procedure.
Diagnostic Imaging Reports	The written results of X-rays, CT scans, MRIs and ultrasounds. The pictures themselves are NOT on this form. Ask the imaging department where the test was done.
Confirmation of Stay (Listing of Visits)	A list of the dates you were seen or admitted. Good for showing how often you have needed care.
Laboratory Reports	Bloodwork and other lab tests.
Pathology Reports	Results from tissue samples, like biopsies.
Consultation Reports	Letters and notes from specialists who saw you.

Tip: name the hospitals and dates as clearly as you can. A narrower request is usually faster and costs less. If you are not sure of the dates, give a range, like "January 2020 to today."

What AHS does not have

- **Family doctor, walk-in clinic or Medi-Centre records:** AHS does not hold these. Contact the clinic directly. You can find a doctor's contact details at search.cpsa.ca.
- **Covenant Health hospitals and sites:** request through covenanthealth.ca (Request health information or health records).
- **Immunization records:** in MyChart, or from your local Public Health office.

What to send with the form

1. The form pages of this working copy: Part A, plus Part B if you are not the patient. You do not need to send these guide pages.

2. A clear copy of ID. Either ONE piece of photo ID (driver's licence, passport, ID card), OR TWO pieces of ID without a photo (health care card, birth certificate, marriage certificate).

3. If you are asking for someone else: proof of your authority, like a guardianship order, parenting order, power of attorney, personal directive, letters of administration, or a signed written authorization from the person.

Where to send it

Email	disclosure@healthsharedservices.ca
Fax	1-855-935-0646
Mail	Alberta Health Services, Room OE1.01, 8440-112 Street, Edmonton, AB T6G 2B7. Attention: Disclosure Help Line
Questions	1-855-312-2265 or disclosure@healthsharedservices.ca

If you email it: put your full name in the subject line, for example *Health Information Access Request - Jane Smith*. You will not have a file number with AHS yet. When they give you a request number, put your full name and that number in the subject line of every email after that. Do not put your health card number in the subject line. Attach the form and your ID.

Keep a copy of everything you send, and write down the date you sent it.

What happens next

- AHS says requests usually take 2 to 4 weeks.
- Records usually come electronically (MyChart, secure file transfer or encrypted email) unless you chose mail.
- The invoice comes with your records.
- Formal request with no answer after 30 days and no extension letter? Follow up in writing. You can also contact the Office of the Information and Privacy Commissioner: 1-888-878-4044.

Signing on a phone

You can print the form and sign by hand, or use a PDF app on your phone that lets you draw your signature (for example the Fill & Sign tool in Adobe Acrobat Reader).

Health Information Access Request

Working copy of AHS form 18577 (Rev2026-07). Everyone fills in Part A. Fill in Part B only if you are not the patient.

PART A - Everyone fills in this part

Select an option

- ☐ I am the patient: complete Part A
- ☐ I am not the patient: complete Parts A and B

Patient Information

Last Name

First Name

Date of Birth (dd-Mon-yyyy)

Personal Health Number/ULI

Requester Information

☐ Same as above (I am the patient)

Last Name

First Name

Requester Contact Information

Mailing Address

City/Town

Province

Postal Code

Email

Phone

You must choose one option (see the guide)

Note from the form: requests made under section 35(1) of the Health Information Act will automatically be processed as informal, even if you select the formal option. This applies to requests for another individual's health information without their consent, where disclosure is authorized under the Act.

- ☐ Option 1: Informal Access Request
- ☐ Option 2: Formal Access Request

Specify the information you require

Name the hospital(s) or site(s):

Up to 300 characters

Date(s) or date range of health information requested:

Up to 150 characters

Select the health information that you require:

- [ ] Discharge Summary
- [ ] Confirmation of Stay (Listing of Visits)
- [ ] Emergency Room Records
- [ ] Laboratory Reports
- [ ] Operative/Procedure Reports
- [ ] Pathology Reports
- [ ] Diagnostic Imaging Reports
- [ ] Consultation Reports

Note from the form: radiographic images must be requested through the diagnostic imaging department at the location where the test was performed.

Specify if you require additional health information that is not listed above:

Up to 400 characters

Select a delivery option

- [ ] Electronic delivery: fastest and most secure method. (The preferred delivery method is MyChart. If you do not have MyChart, other electronic delivery methods will be used.)
- [ ] Mail: information will be sent to the mailing address provided above.
- [ ] Other (specify below)

Other, specify:

Signature of Requester

Signature (sign by hand, or draw it in your PDF app)

Date (dd-Mon-yyyy)

Collection notice, as printed on the official form: The collection of your health information on this form (including the supporting documentation and Personal Health Number) is legally authorized by sections 20(b), 21(1)(a) of the Health Information Act (Alberta). Your information will only be used and disclosed as necessary for responding to your request. If you have any questions about the collection of your personal information as provided on this form, please contact the Disclosure Help Line by emailing disclosure@healthsharedservices.ca, calling 1-855-312-2265 or sending your questions in writing by mail addressed to the attention of Chief Privacy Office, 5th floor, North Tower Seventh Street Plaza, 10030-107 St NW, Edmonton, AB, T5J 3E4.

Before you send it: checklist

- ☐ Part A filled in and signed
- ☐ Copy of ID attached: 1 photo ID, OR 2 pieces of ID without a photo
- ☐ If I am not the patient: Part B filled in, and proof of my authority attached
- ☐ I kept a copy and wrote down the date I sent it

Send to: disclosure@healthsharedservices.ca | Fax 1-855-935-0646 | Mail: Alberta Health Services, Room OE1.01, 8440-112 Street, Edmonton, AB T6G 2B7, Attn: Disclosure Help Line. Do not send payment.

PART B - Only if you are NOT the patient

Specify the reason that you require the information:

Up to 600 characters

Select an option if you are not the patient but are authorized to make the request

Check the appropriate box and provide a copy of the supporting documents that confirm your authority to act on behalf of the patient. Note from the form: requests made under section 35(1) of the Health Information Act will automatically be processed as informal.

- ☐ Parent or legally appointed guardian of an individual under the age of 18 years AND the individual is not a mature minor.
- ☐ Guardian or trustee appointed under the Adult Guardianship and Trusteeship Act AND requested information relates to powers and duties of guardian or trustee.
- ☐ Agent under the Personal Directives Act AND directive has been enacted AND requested information is relevant to a decision the agent is authorized to make.
- ☐ Power of attorney has been granted by the individual AND requested information relates to powers and duties of attorney.
- ☐ Written authorization from the individual to make a request for health information on their behalf.
- ☐ Nearest relative under the Mental Health Act AND requested information is needed to carry out my obligations as the nearest relative. I confirm that, to the best of my knowledge, I am the nearest relative ranked in the order of authority, as defined under the Mental Health Act.

If nearest relative under the Mental Health Act, my relationship to the patient:

Deceased records requests

Specify your relationship and select ONE option.

Relationship:

- ☐ Deceased individual's nearest relative as defined in the Personal Directives Act. By marking this box, I confirm to the best of my knowledge, I am the nearest relative ranked in the order of authority, as defined under the Personal Directives Act.
- ☐ Personal representative of a deceased individual AND requested information is needed to carry out duties related to administration of the individual's estate as outlined in the Estate Administration Act.
- ☐ Requesting health information about a deceased individual and my authority is not clearly listed above.